

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♣

2♠

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

he has not discarded a single ♠. Since you know he started with 6 ♠s, his final 5 cards consist of 4 ♠s and one other. You play to the ♦ A and West follows suit again.

[showcards N:S7,HQ,D5,D4 S:S8,HK,HT,D7]

Play dummy's ♠ 7. West will win, but he has nothing left but ♠s. When he plays another ♠ you discard your ♦ loser and ruff in dummy.

This is called a Partial Elimination because all of the ♦s were not eliminated.

However, the key is that you could tell they were eliminated from the West hand, and West was going to be the throw-in target because of his long ♠s.

In many hands an opponent who opens with a preemptive bid gives you the information you need to plan and execute the throw-in.

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♠ 6, taken by West with the ♠ A. West returns the ♠ Q, you play the ♠ K and East ruffs. East next leads the ♦ J.

After that unfortunate start you seem to be in a bit of trouble. Two tricks are already in the defender's pockets and you still have a ♠ loser and a ♦ loser. So you win with your ♦ K and play two rounds of trumps.

The good news is that East started with three trumps, and since he already used one it only takes two pulls to pick up the remaining trumps.

Eliminate ♣s by playing ♣ A, ♣ K, and ruffing a ♣. Both defenders follow to all three ♣s.

So far West has followed suit to every trick, meaning

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

you will ruff in your hand and discard dummy's ♥ loser. So that defender is going to have to lead a ♥.

If it is South who won the ♦K you are home free. His ♥ play will give you two ♥ tricks.

If it is North who won the ♦K you still have a chance. He will lead a ♥ and you will finesse the ♥Q.

In other words, played this way you make the contract whenever South holds the ♦K **OR** North holds the ♥K.

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With the cards as shown the elimination play works.

But if the ♦K is with North and the ♥K with South it wouldn't.

Of course it is POSSIBLE that if you played a low ♦ from dummy some Easts would duck and let you win a trick with your ♦Q.

This trickery would fail if South held the ♦K, or if North held it and went up right away.

West first transfers you to ♠s, then closes the auction with 4♠.

East is to play 4♠. South leads the ♣2. North takes the ♣A and returns the ♣9 to South's ♣K. South plays another ♣ to your ♣Q.

With two tricks lost already you have a sure ♦ loser (unless the defenders goof) and a ♥ loser that might be taken care of if North holds the ♥K. But what if South holds the ♥K? Maybe an elimination play.

First pull trumps - they split 2-1.

Next eliminate ♦s by playing ♦A then another ♦. This does the elimination and throw-in at the same time.

If the defender who won the ♦K plays a ♦ or a ♣

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 9

North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4
♥ 7 2
♦ Q 8
♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5
♥ A K 10 5
♦ K 7 2
♣ K 7 4



♠ 6
♥ 9 4 3
♦ J 10 9 6
♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 5 4 3
♣ A 9

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 13

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4
♥ 7 2
♦ Q 8
♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5
♥ A K 10 5
♦ K 7 2
♣ K 7 4



♠ 6
♥ 9 4 3
♦ J 10 9 6
♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 5 4 3
♣ A 9

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

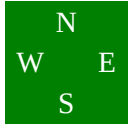
♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

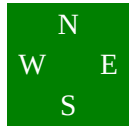
♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4
♥ 7 2
♦ Q 8
♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5
♥ A K 10 5
♦ K 7 2
♣ K 7 4



♠ 6
♥ 9 4 3
♦ J 10 9 6
♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 5 4 3
♣ A 9

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 25

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

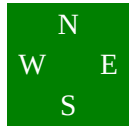
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♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 27

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 29

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

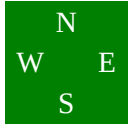
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♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 31

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 33

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 8

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K 10 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 7 4



♠ 6

♥ 9 4 3

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 5 4 3

♣ A 9

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2

Board 35

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 10 9 4
♥ 7 2
♦ Q 8
♣ J 6 5

♠ K 8 5
♥ A K 10 5
♦ K 7 2
♣ K 7 4



♠ 6
♥ 9 4 3
♦ J 10 9 6
♣ Q 10 8 3 2

♠ 7 3 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 5 4 3
♣ A 9

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 9 6 5 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 2

♣ 8 7 6

♠ 8 4

♥ J 10 8

♦ J 10 8 5 4

♣ A 9 3



♠ K Q 10 2

♥ A Q 6 4

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4

♠ 7

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ K 9 6 3

♣ K 10 5 2